

Phase 6: First 90-Day Roadmap

Document type: founder-led 90-day execution roadmap.

Status: internal working document. Use to coordinate product readiness, sales assets, discovery, distribution, pilots, and first-customer conversion.

Required boundary: GCCS is a No-CUI / compliance management MVP. The 90-day roadmap must not expand the product into real CUI handling, formal assessment work, legal advice, accounting advice, CMMC certification, assessor determinations, contracting-officer determinations, or government endorsement claims.

Phase Goal

Get from MVP completion to one contractor who trusts GCCS enough to use it for a real No-CUI compliance workflow and pay for it.

The first milestone is not traffic, impressions, followers, or a long feature backlog. The first milestone is one qualified customer who:

- Pays for the guided pilot or subscription.
- Uses GCCS for a real workflow with synthetic, redacted, or non-sensitive data.
- Gives weekly feedback.
- Provides usable objection and workflow data.
- Either converts or gives a precise reason for not converting.

Critique And Failure Risks

- Building more features before fixing onboarding, demo data, and sales clarity will hide the real adoption blockers.
- Running distribution before the demo and No-CUI language are tight will create trust friction and weak calls.
- Treating discovery calls as validation without payment will overstate willingness to pay.
- Adding features from every prospect will turn the MVP into unfocused consulting work.
- CMMC positioning can become unsafe if it implies certification, official readiness decisions, or assessment success.
- No-CUI posture can fail operationally if product enforcement, onboarding language, support scripts, and demo behavior do not match.

Correct 90-Day Operating Principle

Do the smallest work that increases one of these outcomes:

1. Activation: a qualified user can understand and start the workflow.
2. Reporting: a user can produce a useful workflow artifact.
3. Evidence tracking: a user can organize allowed evidence metadata.
4. Trust: a user understands the No-CUI boundary, source-backed content, auditability, and limitations.
5. Conversion: a pilot prospect can decide whether to pay.

Do not add features outside these five outcomes during the first 90 days.

90-Day Success Definition

Phase 6 is successful if, by Day 90:

- MVP scope is frozen and protected from unrelated feature expansion.
- Onboarding friction is reduced enough for a guided pilot user to reach the core workflow.
- Demo seed data supports a realistic synthetic walkthrough.
- Demo script, landing page, pricing hypothesis, and No-CUI/data-handling language are ready for controlled use.
- At least 100 prospects or advisors are researched.
- At least 10 APEX offices or counselors are contacted.
- At least 30 discovery conversations are completed.
- 3-5 pilot prospects are identified.
- At least 1 pilot is personally onboarded.
- At least 1 pilot converts to paid annual/monthly subscription or produces a precise no-conversion lesson.
- A repeatable onboarding checklist exists.
- A channel and niche decision is made for the next phase.

Days 1-14: Stabilize The MVP And Sales Foundation

Objective

Freeze the MVP, remove activation friction, and prepare controlled demo/sales assets before outreach volume increases.

Required Actions

Action	Owner	Output	Acceptance criteria
Freeze MVP scope	Founder/product	Written scope freeze note	Only activation, reporting, evidence tracking, trust, and conversion blockers can enter the first 90-day backlog.
Fix onboarding friction	Founder/product/engineering	Friction log and fixes	A new guided pilot user can understand where to start, what data is allowed, and how to reach the first workflow step.
Add demo seed data	Engineering/founder	Synthetic demo tenant/data	Demo shows realistic contract metadata, obligations, evidence metadata, report artifact, and audit trail without real CUI.
Create demo script	Founder	Updated demo script	Script follows exact app tabs and includes No-CUI boundary before evidence/upload discussion.
Create landing page	Founder/product	Controlled landing page draft	Page states ICP, painful workflow, No-CUI posture, pilot CTA, pricing hypothesis, and disclaimers.
Create No-CUI/data-handling language	Security/founder/counsel	Reviewed language packet	Language covers prohibited data, customer responsibility, support boundaries, reports, and disclaimers.
Create pricing hypothesis	Founder/finance	Pilot and post-pilot price hypothesis	Pilot price, conversion credit, monthly/annual hypothesis, and disqualification rules are documented.

Scope Freeze Rules

Allowed during Days 1-14:

- Onboarding copy and flow improvements.

- Demo data improvements.
- No-CUI warning and acknowledgement clarity.
- Report/demo reliability fixes.
- Evidence metadata workflow blockers.
- Landing page and sales asset corrections.
- Bugs that block pilot activation.

Not allowed during Days 1-14:

- New broad modules.
- Real CUI support.
- AI assistant expansion.
- Custom integrations.
- Enterprise SSO/SCIM.
- FedRAMP/GovCloud claims.
- Certification or formal assessment workflows.
- Prospect-specific customizations that do not help the first pilot activate.

Day 14 Exit Criteria

- MVP scope freeze is documented.
- Demo tenant can support the minimum demo sequence.
- Landing page draft is ready for controlled review.
- No-CUI/data-handling language is ready for counsel/security review.
- Pricing hypothesis is documented.
- Demo script is ready for recorded walkthrough.

Days 15-30: Create Demand And Validate Language

Objective

Use a controlled demo and targeted prospect list to validate whether the positioning produces conversations.

Required Actions

Action	Owner	Output	Acceptance criteria
Record demo	Founder	3-7 minute demo video	Demo uses synthetic data, states No-CUI boundary, shows core workflow, and ends with pilot CTA.
Build prospect list of 100	Founder	Prospect list	Includes small contractors, advisors, MSPs, compliance consultants, accountants, proposal consultants, and APEX contacts.
Contact 10 APEX offices/counselors	Founder	Outreach log	Messages ask for market learning or educational feedback, not endorsement.
Run 10 discovery calls	Founder	Call notes and scores	Calls use Phase 3 questions and log pain, workflow, objections, No-CUI fit, and pilot interest.

Action	Owner	Output	Acceptance criteria
Refine ICP and language	Founder/product	Updated ICP and message notes	Language uses buyer words from calls and removes vague claims.

Prospect List Requirements

The 100-prospect list should include:

Segment	Minimum count
Small GovCon founders/operators	40
APEX/SBA/GovCon advisors	15
MSPs serving defense contractors	15
Compliance consultants	10
GovCon accountants/bookkeepers	10
Proposal/capture consultants	5
Small prime/subcontractor networks	5

Demo Recording Requirements

The recorded demo must show:

1. Contractor logs in.
2. Dashboard shows readiness status.
3. User opens an obligation.
4. User assigns task/evidence ownership.
5. User sees source-backed content.
6. User exports or generates a readiness/report artifact.
7. User sees audit trail where permitted.
8. User sees No-CUI warning before upload/data-entry risk.

Day 30 Exit Criteria

- Demo recording exists.
- 100-prospect list exists.
- 10 APEX/advisor contacts have been sent.
- 10 discovery calls are completed or scheduled with notes.
- Top 3 objections are documented.
- ICP language is refined from real conversations.

Days 31-60: Convert Pilot Prospects And Onboard Manually

Objective

Convert discovery signal into 3-5 qualified pilot prospects and personally onboard each selected pilot.

Required Actions

Action	Owner	Output	Acceptance criteria
Run 20 more calls	Founder	20 logged calls	Total call count reaches 30 and each call has score, objection, No-CUI fit, and next action.
Convert 3-5 pilot prospects	Founder	Pilot candidate scorecards	Prospects meet Phase 4 criteria: money, workflow data, weekly feedback, anonymized-learning permission, testimonial willingness if successful.
Personally onboard each pilot	Founder/product	Onboarding notes	Founder observes setup, confusion, blocked steps, and trust objections directly.
Track every objection	Founder	Objection log	Objections are grouped by trust, data posture, price, workflow, reporting, evidence, or product gap.
Add only blocker features	Founder/product/engineering	Blocker-only backlog	Only activation, reporting, evidence tracking, or trust blockers are eligible.

Feature Triage Rule

Do not ask "Would this be useful?"

Ask:

1. Does this block activation?
2. Does this block report generation?
3. Does this block evidence metadata tracking?
4. Does this block trust in the No-CUI/source-backed workflow?
5. Does this block a paid conversion decision?

If the answer is No to all five, defer the feature.

Objection Categories

Track objections in these categories:

Category	Examples	Response
No-CUI/data posture	"We need to upload CUI."	Disqualify or route to future roadmap. Do not force the MVP.
Certification expectation	"Will this certify us?"	Clarify readiness support only, not certification.
Legal/accounting advice	"Can you tell us what this means legally?"	Refer to qualified advisor. GCCS tracks workflow.
Price	"Why pay for a pilot?"	Explain commitment, guided setup, and conversion credit.
Workflow fit	"This is not our process."	Capture specific mismatch; only fix if repeated.
Reporting	"The report is not useful yet."	Prioritize if it blocks conversion.
Evidence tracking	"We still need spreadsheets."	Prioritize if it blocks activation.
Trust	"Can we trust the content?"	Emphasize source-backed/reviewable content and disclaimers.

Day 60 Exit Criteria

- 30 total discovery calls are completed or materially scheduled.
- 3-5 pilot prospects are identified and scored.

- At least 1 pilot is in kickoff or pre-payment review.
- Objection log is current.
- Product backlog is limited to activation, reporting, evidence tracking, and trust blockers.

Days 61-90: Convert, Publish Proof, And Pick The Niche

Objective

Turn a pilot into paid subscription or concrete learning, then package proof and choose the next distribution focus.

Required Actions

Action	Owner	Output	Acceptance criteria
Convert one pilot to paid annual/monthly	Founder	Paid conversion or precise loss reason	Decision is written: annual, monthly, paid extension, or no-conversion reason.
Publish one case study or anonymized workflow teardown	Founder/marketing/counsel	Case study draft	Uses only approved, anonymized, non-sensitive, permissioned content.
Build partner/referral package	Founder	Partner package	Includes No-CUI policy, sample workflow, sample report, pilot offer, referral criteria, and claims guardrails.
Create repeatable onboarding checklist	Founder/product	Onboarding checklist	Checklist allows the next pilot to be onboarded with less founder improvisation.
Decide niche focus	Founder/product	Niche decision memo	Choose CMMC readiness, general GovCon compliance tracking, subcontractor readiness, or evidence management.

Niche Decision Framework

Choose the niche with the strongest evidence, not the largest theoretical market.

Niche	Choose if the evidence shows
CMMC readiness	Buyers repeatedly need readiness workflow support but understand GCCS is not a certifier or assessor.
General GovCon compliance tracking	Buyers have broad recurring task/evidence/reporting pain across contracts and programs.
Subcontractor readiness	Primes or subcontractors repeatedly ask for proof, flow-down tracking, or subcontractor status evidence.
Evidence management	Buyers repeatedly lose evidence metadata, owners, dates, or report-ready proof.

Case Study Rules

Before publishing any case study, confirm:

- Counsel has reviewed the format.
- Customer permission exists if the customer is named.
- If permission is not explicit, publish only anonymized workflow teardown.
- No CUI, sensitive data, contract documents, screenshots with customer data, or private identifiers are included.
- Results are described as workflow outcomes, not compliance certification.
- Any quote is approved in writing.

Partner/Referral Package Contents

The first partner package should include:

- One-paragraph GCCS description.
- No-CUI policy summary.
- Ideal customer profile.
- Disqualification criteria.
- 30-day guided pilot summary.
- Sample obligation/evidence workflow.
- Sample readiness report.
- Security/data-handling page.
- Referral intake questions.
- Claims guardrails.
- Founder contact path.

Day 90 Exit Criteria

- One pilot has converted, extended under paid scope, or produced a precise no-conversion reason.
- One proof asset exists: case study, anonymized workflow teardown, or pilot-learning memo.
- Partner/referral package exists.
- Repeatable onboarding checklist exists.
- Niche decision is documented.
- Next 90-day plan is based on paid-pilot evidence, not opinions.

Weekly Operating Cadence

Use this cadence every week during the first 90 days.

Meeting	Duration	Required output
Monday planning	30 minutes	Weekly target list, calls, demos, pilots, and product blockers.
Wednesday pipeline review	20 minutes	Outreach count, replies, calls, pilot candidates, blocked deals.
Friday learning review	45 minutes	Objections, product blockers, message changes, next-week decisions.

Metrics Dashboard

Track these weekly in `phase-6-90-day-roadmap-tracker.csv` (`./phase-6-90-day-roadmap-tracker.csv`).

Metric	Target by Day 90
Prospects researched	100+
APEX/advisor contacts	10+
Discovery calls completed	30
Demos delivered	5-10
Pilot prospects scored	3-5

Metric	Target by Day 90
Paid pilots closed	1+
Pilot conversion or precise loss reason	1
Published proof asset	1
Partner/referral package	1
Repeatable onboarding checklist	1
Niche decision memo	1

Required Artifacts

Artifact	Existing or new source
Scope freeze note	Create during Days 1-14.
Demo script	Minimum Demo Structure (./minimum-demo-structure.md).
Landing page copy	Use Positioning And Messaging (./phase-1-positioning-messaging.md), One-Page Offer (./phase-1-one-page-offer.md), and Pricing Page (./pricing-page-founder-pilot.md).
No-CUI/data-handling language	No-CUI Policy Statement (./no-cui-policy-statement.md), Security And Data-Handling Page (./security-and-data-handling-page.md), Terms And Disclaimer Language (./terms-disclaimer-counsel-review.md).
Pricing hypothesis	Pricing Page With Founder-Friendly Pilot Option (./pricing-page-founder-pilot.md).
Prospect list	Use Phase 3 and Phase 5 targeting.
Discovery call guide	Phase 3: Validate With 20 Conversations (./phase-3-validate-with-20-conversations.md).
Pilot offer	Phase 4: Create A Pilot Offer (./phase-4-create-a-pilot-offer.md).
Distribution guide	Phase 5: Distribution Channels (./phase-5-distribution-channels.md).
Partner/referral package	Create during Days 61-90 from approved assets.
Onboarding checklist	Create during Days 61-90 from actual pilot setup steps.

Actionable Backlog Template

Use this backlog format for every task during Phase 6.

Field	Required value
Task	Specific action.
Phase window	Days 1-14, 15-30, 31-60, or 61-90.
Owner	Founder, product, engineering, security, counsel, finance.
Outcome type	Activation, reporting, evidence tracking, trust, conversion, distribution.
Acceptance criteria	What proves completion.
Dependency	Asset, review, code change, customer input, or external partner.
Status	Not started, in progress, blocked, done.

Do-Not-Do List

Do not do these during the first 90 days:

- Buy broad ads before paid-pilot evidence.

- Build a large feature backlog from unqualified calls.
- Sell certification or assessment outcomes.
- Accept real CUI into the MVP.
- Let pilots run without payment, written scope, or a decision date.
- Build custom integrations for the first pilot.
- Publish named case studies without permission.
- Create a formal referral fee program before counsel review.
- Chase enterprise procurement requirements before the first small-contractor workflow is proven.

Rationale

This market has high trust friction and low tolerance for vague compliance claims. The correct path is narrow positioning, direct validation, guided pilots, and partner-led distribution.

Small contractors may not trust a new SaaS product with compliance-adjacent workflows until the product proves:

- It respects data boundaries.
- It does not overclaim certification or legal authority.
- It makes the workflow easier than spreadsheets.
- It produces useful report artifacts.
- It gives advisors and internal owners more control, not more work.

Your first milestone is not traffic. It is one contractor who trusts the product enough to use it for a real compliance workflow and pay for it.

Hidden Risks, Edge Cases, And Dependencies

- Legal review is required for disclaimers, terms, pricing, pilot language, testimonials, referral language, and marketing claims before charging customers at scale.
- If users upload CUI despite warnings, the No-CUI posture can fail operationally unless the product, onboarding, support process, and incident response enforce the boundary.
- Compliance content must stay source-backed, reviewable, and governed by qualified subject-matter review.
- CMMC-related positioning must be precise: readiness support, not certification, assessor determination, or assessment success.
- Small contractors may want services more than software; early revenue may require guided onboarding while the software motion matures.
- Advisors may become the strongest channel only if GCCS makes them look better to clients and reduces follow-through burden.
- Pricing is unproven until buyers pay. Interviews alone do not validate willingness to pay.
- A first converted pilot does not prove scalable acquisition. Track founder time, support burden, and manual work so the next phase can remove bottlenecks.

Related Documents

- Phase 1: Lock The Offer (./phase-1-lock-the-offer.md)
- Phase 2 Sales Assets Index (./phase-2-sales-assets-index.md)
- Phase 3: Validate With 20 Conversations (./phase-3-validate-with-20-conversations.md)

- Phase 4: Create A Pilot Offer (./phase-4-create-a-pilot-offer.md)
- Phase 5: Distribution Channels (./phase-5-distribution-channels.md)
- Minimum Demo Structure (./minimum-demo-structure.md)
- No-CUI Policy Statement (./no-cui-policy-statement.md)
- Terms And Disclaimer Language For Counsel Review (./terms-disclaimer-counsel-review.md)